



# THE FINAL SOLUTION OF THE JEWISH QUESTION

THE WANNSEE CONFERENCE (1942)

## IN CONTEXT

### FOCUS

#### The Holocaust

### BEFORE

**1933** The first concentration camp is built in Dachau, near Munich. Its first inmates are communists, socialists, and trade unionists.

**September 1935** As a result of the new Nuremberg Laws, Jews lose their civil rights.

**1938** During Kristallnacht, the “Night of Broken Glass,” the Nazis terrorize Jews across Germany and Austria.

**June 1941** The German invasion of the Soviet Union is accompanied by the mass killing of Jews.

### AFTER

**May 1942** Gassings start at Auschwitz, in Poland.

**1945–1946** At the Nuremberg trials, 24 Nazi members are indicted and 12 sentenced to death.

**O**n January 20, 1942, 15 members of the Nazi Party and German officials met in the Berlin suburb of Wannsee to discuss the implementation of the “Final Solution of the Jewish Question”—the code name for the systematic annihilation of European Jews. During the conference, a

**Hitler** becomes ruler of Germany and **introduces legislation** discriminating against Jews.



Hitler’s takeover of Austria is followed by **widespread attacks on Jews**.



**Germany conquers Poland**, and Polish Jews are forced to move into **overcrowded ghettos**.



The Nazis look for **efficient ways** to kill millions after the **invasion of Russia**.



**The Wannsee Conference organizes the Final Solution.**



More than **6 million Jews** are killed in **the Holocaust**.

tabulation of all the Jews in Europe was presented, country by country, as well as a target number for extermination: 11 million. The meeting lasted two hours and was matter-of-fact and dispassionate. After approving the “Final Solution” and the slaughter of the Jews, the men called for brandy and cigars.